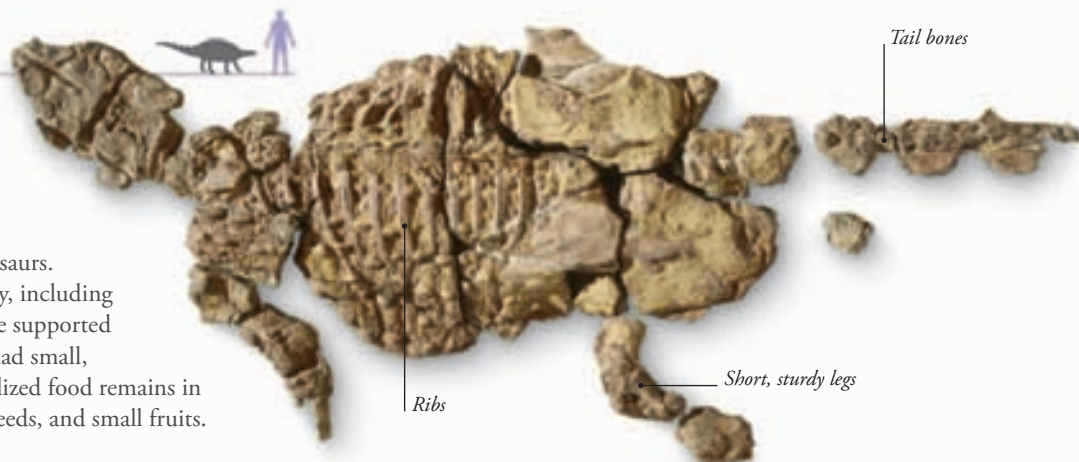


Minmi

MIN-mee

- **When** 120–115 million years ago (Early Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** Australia
- **Habitat** Scrubby and wooded plains
- **Length** 10 ft (3 m)
- **Diet** Leaves, seeds, small fruit

Minmi was one of the smallest of the ankylosaurs. Small, rounded armor plates covered its body, including its belly. Extra bones along its back may have supported its back muscles. Its beak was sharp, and it had small, leaf-shaped teeth with sawtooth edges. Fossilized food remains in the belly of *Minmi* reveal that it ate leaves, seeds, and small fruits.



Gastonia

gas-TOE-nee-ah

- **When** 125 million years ago (Early Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** USA
- **Habitat** Woodlands
- **Length** 13 ft (4 m)
- **Diet** Plants

Only the bravest or most desperate predator would risk attacking *Gastonia*. A walking fortress, it was covered from head to tail with rows of huge, bladelike spikes of bone. It had no tail club, but its spiked tail could swing from side to side to inflict savage injuries. The bone forming the top of its skull was dome-shaped and extra thick—perhaps males had head-butting contests over territories or mates.



Gargoylesaurus

GAR-goil-oh-SORE-us

- **When** 155–145 million years ago (Late Jurassic)
- **Fossil location** USA
- **Habitat** Woodlands
- **Length** 13 ft (4 m)
- **Diet** Low-lying vegetation

Gargoylesaurus had many unusual features for an ankylosaur. Unlike other members of the family, it had teeth at the front of the upper jaw, and its armor plates were hollow. It also had straight nostrils instead of the odd, looping ones seen in other ankylosaurs.



Sauropelta

SORE-oh-PELT-ah

- **When** 120–110 million years ago (Early Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** USA
- **Habitat** Woodlands
- **Length** 16 ft (5 m)
- **Diet** Plants

hornlike spikes. A thick shield of armor plates covered its back and tail, giving *Sauropelta* its name ("shield lizard"). The shield was a jigsaw of small plates of bone that fitted together like tiles.

Predators risked deadly injury if they tried to bite this dinosaur's neck, which bristled with vicious,

